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Perishable Export Compliance Checklist – 2025 Edition

This checklist helps African exporters prepare perishable goods for cross-border shipping.

1. Product Assessment

- ☐ Confirm the product is eligible for export in the destination country.
- ☐ Verify shelf life and temperature sensitivity.
- ☐ Check required handling and packaging standards.

2. Packaging Requirements

- ☐ Use insulated boxes or cold chain-certified containers.
- ☐ Add gel packs or dry ice as required.
- ☐ Vacuum-seal items to prevent contamination.
- ☐ Attach ‘Perishable Goods’ labels clearly.

3. Documentation Checklist

- ☐ Health certificate issued by a recognized authority.
- ☐ Export permit for regulated perishables.
- ☐ Certificate of origin.
- ☐ Temperature log sheet (where applicable).
- ☐ Airline or courier-specific declaration forms.

4. ColdChain Integrity

- ☐ Precool products before packaging.
- ☐ Ensure continuous cold storage until dispatch.
- ☐ Use temperature loggers or smart tracking devices.

5. Transport & Timing

- ☐ Select the fastest route (air recommended).
- ☐ Plan shipment around weekends/holidays to avoid delays.
- ☐ Confirm the carrier accepts perishables and the required conditions.

6. Customs & Inspection

- ☐ Verify destination import restrictions.
- ☐ Ensure proper labeling and documentation accuracy.
- ☐ Prepare for physical inspection if required.

7. Final Cross Check Before Dispatch

- ☐ Reconfirm temperature stability.
- ☐ Recheck packaging seals and insulation.
- ☐ Upload all documents to your logistics or courier platform.

Before every shipment, move through each section step-by-step. Tick off completed tasks, verify that your documents are accurate, and ensure your packaging meets cold-chain standards. Use it as your final pre-dispatch control tool to avoid delays, spoilage, or failed inspections.

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